

Pablo M. Guzmán Lizardo

PhD Candidate in Political Economics at the Stanford Graduate School of Business
655 Knight Way, Stanford, CA 94305, USA

✉ pablo@guzmanlizardo.com 🌐 pguzmanlizardo.github.io

EDUCATION

Stanford Graduate School of Business *PhD Candidate in Political Economics* 2021 - Present
Fields: Political Economics, Public Economics, Development Economics.
Expected Graduation: June 2026

McGill University, *B.A. Economics and B.A. Political Science* 2017-2021
First Class Honours in Political Science
First Class Honours in Economics
Dean's Honour List

Research and Work Experience

Principal Researcher, *Impact Evaluation: Motivating Property Tax Compliance* 2023-Present
Co-principal investigator in an impact evaluation of strategies to promote property tax compliance in Kenema, Sierra Leone.

- Increased property tax compliance by over 50 p.p. in the treated groups, doubling tax revenues in the city.
- Designed and implemented an impact evaluation of strategies to promote tax compliance. Impacted over 6000 property owners, over a third of city's tax defaulters.
- Collaborated with the local government to design, implement, and evaluate the its tax enforcement policy.
- Coordinated with Chiefly Traditional Authorities to set up a new Traditional Tax Court system to judge over 3000 tax defaulters.
- Collaborated with Muslim and Christian organizations to implement a public campaign motivating tax compliance involving over 3000 tax defaulters.
- Led three waves of survey data collection with a team of over 6 research assistants, 4 field coordinators, and over 60 enumerators.
- Over a year of direct, in-field experience in Kenema, Sierra Leone.
- Raised over USD \$ 300,000 in research grants to implement this impact evaluation.

Principal Researcher, *Impact Evaluation: Effect of Militarized Policing* 2023
Implemented an impact evaluation of the effects of militarized policing in Dominican Republic.

- Collaborated with the Ministry of Defense, and directly engaged with the Minister and the institution's leadership to initiate and coordinate the evaluation.
- Collected and digitize administrative data on patrolling activities in the country.
- Built a novel panel dataset tracking all instances of militarized patrolling in the country between January 2023 and June 2023.
- Applied novel econometric methods to estimate the effect of militarized policing on crime in the country.

Graduate Research Assistant, *Impact Evaluation: Candidate Entry Into Local Government* 2022
Graduate research assistant under Professor Katherine Casey on an experimental intervention

that identified, screened, and promoted high-quality potential candidates for political office in Sierra Leone.

- a. 4 months of in-field, operational assistance in Sierra Leone.
- b. Supervised survey data collection across the country.
- c. Implemented data analysis and manipulation tasks, supporting the project's activities.

Undergraduate Research Assistant, *Impact Evaluation: Micro-savings groups* 2018-2021
Research assistant under Professor Laura Doering on an impact evaluation of micro-savings groups in Colombia. Over 3 years of off-field research, data analysis, and data manipulation support in Stata.

Ongoing Research Projects

Does Information about Enforcement Lead to Compliance?

Together with Wilson Prichard and Niccolò Meriggi

Together with the Sierra Leone Association of Journalists, we evaluate the effect of spreading journalistic pamphlets about government tax enforcement action on the likelihood of compliance. We implement a Saturation Experimental Design to evaluate both the direct effect of receiving the pamphlets and the indirect effects of being informed about the pamphlets.

Aligning Enforcement Officer Incentives

Together with Wilson Prichard and Niccolò Meriggi

Leveraging a property tax reform in Kenema, Sierra Leone, we evaluate different incentive structures to motivate productivity and reduce corruption of tax enforcement officers.

Mapping Attitudes Towards Taxation in Sierra Leone

Together with Wilson Prichard and Niccolò Meriggi

Across several city-wide property tax interventions in Sierra Leone, we map the evolution of attitudes towards property taxation and fiscal capacity across time and across several cities.

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY SERVICE

Course Assistant, *Stanford Graduate School of Business* 2025
Course assistant under Professor Katherine Casey.

- a. Assisted on teaching activities for the Strategy Beyond Markets course at the Stanford Graduate School of Business.
- b. Supported early- and mid-career MBA students on course content and concepts.
- c. Supported course organization and management.

Conference Co-Organizer, *DevPec* April 2024

- a. Co-organized the 2024 edition of the student-led Development and Political Economics Conference (DevPEC).
- b. Collaborated with a team of PhD students from Stanford University's Economics Department and the University of Berkeley's Economics Department.

AWARDS AND RESEARCH GRANTS

International Growth Centre Full Research Grant, £75,000 2024
Local Government Revenue Initiative Grant, €188,664 2024

Local Government Revenue Initiative Grant, *USD \$51,165*
International Growth Centre Small Projects Fund, *£19,000*

2024
2024

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Languages: English (Bilingual), Spanish (Native), French (Advanced), Portuguese (Advanced), Sierra Leonean Krio (Beginner).

Programming and Statistical Packages: R, Python, Stata, SPSS, SQL.

Citizenship: Dominican Republic.

REFERENCES

Professor Katherine Casey

Stanford Graduate School of Business

Academic supervisor within doctorate program

Email: kecasey@stanford.edu

Professor Caroline Hoxby

Stanford University Department of Economics

Academic supervisor within doctorate program

Email: choxby@stanford.edu

Professor Beatriz Magaloni-Kerpel

Stanford University Department of Political Science

Academic supervisor within doctorate program

Email: magaloni@stanford.edu

Professor Wilson Prichard

Munk School of Global Affairs & Public Policy

Co-author and policy collaborator

Email: wilson.prichard@utoronto.ca